MOCK TEST 17

READING

5 parts · 35 questions

60 minutes

Vaqt: 60 daqiqa. Javoblarni javoblar varaqasiga o'tkazishni unutmang.

PART 1

Questions 1–7

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

FREE THINGS TO DO IN NEW YORK CITY

Touring New York City and visiting its attractions can be a costly affair, especially if you visit the Empire State Building, Statue of Liberty, or attend special events and dine in fancy restaurants. However, this does not indicate that you have to empty your pockets to experience the New York life and its **Q1** _____ The city offers a fair share of landmark attractions and activities that are absolutely free and may actually present a more local insight of the city than paid attractions. Mentioned below is a list of free things to do in the city that never sleeps.

Belvedere Castle

The heart of Central Park holds one of New York's most treasured attractions – the Belvedere Castle. Built in 1869, this Victorian castle has many exhibit rooms and an observation deck. Admission to the castle is free of charge. You can visit the site's Henry Luce Nature Observatory, which **Q2**_____ diverse displays of plants and animals. If you step up the **Q3** _____ tower, you can get spectacular views of Central Park.

Brooklyn Bridge

Many tourists click postcard-worth pictures of the Brooklyn Bridge. But, you can also take a walk on the bridge as car whizz past you. Brooklyn Bridge has a pedestrian walkway right in the middle of its six lanes. The **Q4**_____ keeps you safe from the traffic and it is absolutely free to cross the Brooklyn Bridge on foot. It will take you approximately 30 minutes to cross the bridge and you can get to see stunning **Q5** _____ of downtown Manhattan.

Grand Central Terminal

Built in 1913, the Grand Central Terminal is a major hub of the city's public transportation. It serves more than 575,000 commuters every day. You can stroll in the station for **Q6** _____ and check out the shopping spots and places to eat. The grand building also exhibits beautiful artwork and sculpture. You may also chance upon special exhibitions or seasonal vendors.

Staten Island Ferry

The Staten Island Ferry ride is one of the most fun and free things to do in New York City. It is a 25-minute boat ride that sails between Manhattan and St. George on Staten Island. You can also get a close view of the Statue of Liberty. Once you disembark on Staten Island, then you can spend hours on the island to discover the interesting sights and attractions. When you have your fill, you can board the **Q7**_____ to return to Manhattan.

PART 2

Questions 8–14

Read the descriptions of eight courses. Decide which course would be the most suitable for you. For Questions 8-14, select the best course.

8

Person 8

You are an accomplished photographer looking for an enjoyable course where you can improve your skills. You love taking pictures outdoors and are only free at weekends.

9

Person 9

You have painted for 10 years and want to learn about the work of famous painters from the past. You are looking for a day-time course that will help you improve your painting skills.

10

Person 10

You are 32 and you would like to do computer studies in Manchester. You want to do a part-time course which includes theory and practical skills. In your spare time you paint and draw.

11

Person 11

You would like a course where you can learn the basic concepts of drawing. You work in the morning but are free at weekends. You are most interested in drawing portraits but do not need a qualification.

12

Person 12

You are 25. You want to take up an activity that will give you a lot of contact with other people. You are very talented and like performing.

13

Person 13

You are not very fit. You would like to get fitter, but you find exercise boring. You are looking for an evening class that is different every week. You would also like to see how you are improving over time.

14

Person 14

You take sport seriously. You play hockey and tennis and want to improve your skills and take part in competitions. You are not free from Monday to Friday.

A) VR-RuN! Have fun and get fit at your local sports centre! Classes every Tuesday and Thursday from 6-8 p.m. No two classes are the same! We organize regular competitions and also offer individual fitness checks every month, plus the chance to gain progress certificates.

B) Jennifer Collins Theatre School. The aim of this course is to provide participants with the opportunity to train to the highest standards for a professional career in Dance and Musical Theatre. We offer a chance to meet new friends in a very happy environment.

C) The Open University. Our Adult courses give you the chance to boost your confidence and develop your work skills. This cutting-edge course will prepare you for progression to further study in computing and software development. Full-time and part-time courses are available.

D) 3D Studio. 3D Studio has a fun 34-week photo challenge. All courses are led by a professional photographer who has specific skills to teach you. By learning with 3D Studio you will be taken to the best places and venues in the countryside. The course takes place on Saturdays, 3.30-6.00 p.m.

E) Adam Elliot Studio. During this workshop students will be taught the classical methods of oil painting used by Italian and Flemish masters of the late 16th and early 17th centuries. This workshop is suitable for students of all levels of experience. Classes are on Monday and Wednesday from 9-11 a.m.

F) Santa Reparata. The main aim of this short course is to provide an introduction to one of the most fascinating period of the Italian Art. The one week painting course is suitable for absolute beginners. Classes are from 6.30-9.30 p.m. Monday to Friday.

G) Rising Stars. We believe sports are for winners! We offer training from professional sports coaches to help you become a more successful player. Choose from a range of team and racket sports. Players are encouraged to join local and national leagues. Classes: every Saturday and Sunday, or book an individual lesson with one of our trainers.

H) The Art Academy. This is an informative, intensive, and fun weekend course, which teaches essential drawing skills. Through various drawing approaches including life drawing, portraiture and still life, you will learn to understand texture, line, measurement and composition.

PART 3

Questions 15–20

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

I) Health benefits of soursops
II) The soursop tree
III) Side effects of soursops
IV) Effectiveness in destroying cancerous cells
V) Recent scientific discoveries on the tree
VI) Nutrients in soursop fruits
VII) The soursop fruit
VIII) The use of various parts of the tree

15. Paragraph A **16. Paragraph B** **17. Paragraph C**
18. Paragraph D **19. Paragraph E** **20. Paragraph F**

SOURSOP FRUIT

A. The soursop tree is known for its delicious fruits. The fruit is large with a thin, green-colored skin covered with conical nibs. The pulp is white and soft, and quite delicious. It has both sweet and sour taste. The fruit can be eaten directly, or its pulp can be pressed and strained to extract the juice, which is not only delectable, but also rich in many essential nutrients.

B. The flesh or pulp of the fruit, from which the juice is extracted, is very rich in fiber, carbohydrates, and other nutrients, like vitamin B1 and B2, vitamin C, and potassium. On the other hand, it is quite low in saturated fats and sodium. About 1 cup of undiluted juice or nectar contains 160 calories.

C. The soursop tree is mainly known for its medicinal properties. Certain compounds found in the extracts derived from the fruits, seeds, bark, and the leaves of the soursop tree have been observed to be effective in destroying cancerous cells in some laboratory studies. The leaves of this tree have been found to be particularly effective in killing cancer cells without harming the healthy cells of the body. Moreover, the extract derived from the leaves does not affect the immune system adversely, unlike the chemotherapy drugs.

D. Apart from the ability to kill cancer cells, the soursop tree has several other health benefits. The seeds of this fruit can be used for inducing vomiting, while the juice can be immensely beneficial for treating urethritis. It can also help treat hematuria which is a condition characterized by the presence of blood in urine. Soursop juice can help alleviate liver ailments as well. The juice is usually taken while fasting in order to cure liver problems. It may also prove beneficial in conditions like leprosy.

E. The various parts of the tree, including its leaves and the young shoots have been used for conditions, like cough, catarrh, fever, gallbladder problems, inflammation and swelling, diarrhea, indigestion, rheumatism, dysentery, eczema, and some other skin problems. The pulp of the fruit, as well as the crushed leaves of the tree, can be used as a poultice to ensure fast healing of wounds.

F. To sum up, soursop is not only a delicious, but also a very nutritious fruit. However, it is imperative to talk to a physician before considering to use it for medicinal purposes. If taken in large dosage, it can induce vomiting and depress the

cardiovascular system. It can also induce uterine contractions, for which pregnant women should not use this fruit for medicinal purposes. All these possible side effects need to be considered before using this fruit, or any other part of the tree for the treatment of cancer and other ailments.

PART 4

Questions 21–29

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

THE CONTRIBUTION OF LANGUAGE TO BUSINESS

People say that business is all about relationships, but the truth is that business is really all about language communication. Languages make either a direct or indirect contribution to business and industry—from acquiring and retaining customers to improving employee engagement and performance. At the most fundamental level, business cannot happen without communication. This is even more true in the era of globalization. As geographic borders become porous and the world flattens, effective communication with customers, employees, partners, suppliers, and other stakeholders across the globe becomes essential to successfully running a company.

There is no universal agreement on how significant the language factor is; nor the degree of language proficiency in contribution to the success of business and industry. In large modern enterprises, people have the unique experience of working with thousands of organizations across different industries and sectors that are tackling this very problem. Companies adjust to these demographic, cultural, and economic trends and proactively build workforces with the skills and capabilities needed to grow and thrive in this multicultural and international economy. Although the combination of business functions and processes impacted by improved communication may vary from company to company, language skills consistently deliver tangible business value and results for organizations that invest in language training.

Although English is dominant for international transactions, many business people also think and deal in scores of languages. Companies that operate solely in English will miss opportunities to capitalize on the explosive growth in developing and untapped markets at home and abroad. These companies also run the risk of misunderstandings with customers, and with members of an increasingly global workforce. Moreover, travellers on business need to have different levels of language proficiency. On a basic level, they are able to use the language at the airport and to check in at the hotel. Besides, they need a high language proficiency to deal with workers at their offshore factories.

One of the biggest business advantages of a workforce that can effectively communicate in more than one language is the ability to reach new markets—both at home and abroad. On the domestic side, for example, the U.S. has become even more of a melting pot than in the past, with minorities accounting for a greater proportion of the total population. Accordingly, in domestic venues, the consumer contacts and service activities also ask for workers with good skills of different languages, such as at restaurants or in duty-free stores.

The language proficiency needed to hold a conversation is quite different from that needed for negotiating. Receptionists and telephonists are the first point of contact between firms. The language proficiency they need is to gather basic factual information. Yet negotiating well in another language is one of the most difficult skills, especially nowadays when it is often done at a distance by videoconference, teleconference or email. It is also one of the most important things to do well, with usually a clear financial penalty for doing it badly. To really master the negotiating skill, negotiators need a thorough understanding of the very many phrases they might hear during a negotiation and an ability to show fine shades in meaning in their own contributions. Similar to negotiating, certain occupations like shipping, also require unbroken and detailed communication between officials.

When it comes to negotiation, the interpreters and translators are needed. Interpreters and translators aid communication by converting messages or text from one language into another language. Although some people do both, interpreting and translating are different professions: interpreters work with spoken communication, and translators work with written communication. The selection of interpreters and translators is critical. Both the loyalty and accuracy of the interpreters and translators must be put at the top of agenda. Thus, loyalty to the speaker and the original appears to be a hallmark of professionals more so than of amateurs.

Who can judge the performance of the interpreters? A person with language proficiency is needed in the negotiating team to check on the interpreters, guaranteeing the quality and accuracy of the interpretation. Listeners are presumably listening only to the output and as such not aware of the structure of the source speech. Only an experienced expert will understand the constraints of any given situation and be in a position to judge. Only she (or he) can assess just how the speed, density and complexity of the speech will affect interpretation in any particular language combination. And even this task is not easy: interpreters are trained to listen and speak at the same time, not to listen to two different audio streams. Therefore, the check-on is best accomplished by those trained to teach or with enough experience to have mastered this skill.

Businesses may ask help from local consultants who are responsible for hiring local workers or train company managers to deal with local consumers. That was the case with CommScope, a multibillion dollar telecom equipment manufacturer with customers, employees, and partners in 18 countries across the world. In the wake of these transactions, the company began offering Jacqueline K. Crofton, a local resident, language training to key employees and executives. The goal of the training was not to make employees fluent in the new language, as much as to give them a degree of functional proficiency. "In order to advance well in new markets and with new customers, we had to be able to at least understand and communicate at a basic level, even with the use of interpreters," says David Hartsoe, manager of CommScope's Global Learning Center. In the long run, effective communication will definitely help their employees stay positive and productive.

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the text?

21 There are two types of contribution that languages make to business.

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

22 **All businesses have recognized the importance of language to business.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

23 **English is the most important language for all business purposes.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

24 **Senior executives, especially, need to be fluent in the language of their trading partners.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

25 **Travellers on business need several different levels of language proficiency.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

26 **Some businesses provide interpreter training to their employees.**

A) True
B) False
C) Not Given

For questions 27-29, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D.

27 **One of the most important qualities of the interpreter is**

A) common sense.
B) industry knowledge and contacts.
C) appropriate reaction.
D) trustworthiness.

28 **A qualified interpreter is essential to the business for**

A) ensuring cultural appropriateness.
B) accuracy of information.
C) success in trading.
D) financial reasons.

29 **In the writer's opinion, hiring an indigenous person to improve the dialect language proficiency of the company staff is**

A) unethical.
B) unlikely.
C) sensible.
D) expensive.

PART 5

Questions 30–35

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

ARCHITECTURE IN BRITAIN

From the Middle Ages to the 20th century, what are the influences and movements that have shaped the changing face of British architecture?

Romano-British culture—and that included architecture along with language, religion, political organisation and the arts—survived long after the Roman withdrawal. And although the Anglo-Saxons had a sophisticated building style of their own, little survives to bear witness to their achievements as the vast majority of Anglo-Saxon buildings were made of wood.

Even so, the period between the Norman landing at Pevensey in 1066 and the day in 1485 when Richard III lost his horse and his head at Bosworth, ushering in the Tudors and the Early Modern period, marks a rare flowering of British buildings. And it is all the more remarkable because the underlying ethos of medieval architecture was "fitness for purpose". The great cathedrals and parish churches that lifted up their towers to heaven were not only acts of devotion in stone; they were also fiercely functional buildings. Castles served their particular purpose and their battlements and turrets were for use rather than ornament. The rambling manor houses of the later Middle Ages, however, were primarily homes, their owners achieving respect and maintaining status by their hospitality and good lordship rather than the grandeur of their buildings. In a sense, the buildings of the 16th century were also governed by fitness for purpose—only now, the purpose was very different. In domestic architecture, in particular, buildings were used to display status and wealth.

This stately and curious workmanship showed itself in various ways. A greater sense of security led to more outward-looking buildings, as opposed to the medieval arrangement where the need for defence created houses that faced inward onto a courtyard or series of courtyards. This allowed for much more in the way of exterior ornament. The rooms themselves tended to be bigger and lighter—as an expensive commodity, the use of great expanses of glass was in itself a statement of wealth. There was also a general move towards balanced and symmetrical exteriors with central entrances. With the exception of Indigo Jones (1573-1652), whose confident handling of classical detail and proportion set him apart from all other architects of the period, most early 17th century buildings tended to take the innocent exuberance of late Tudor work one step further. But during the 1640s and 50s the Civil War and its aftermath sent many gentlemen and nobles to the Continent either to escape the fighting or, when the war was lost, to follow Charles II into exile. There they came into contact with French, Dutch and Italian architecture and, with Charles's restoration in 1660, there was a flurry of building activity as royalists reclaimed their property and built themselves houses reflecting the latest European trends. The British Baroque was a reassertion of authority, an expression of absolutist ideology by men who remembered a world turned upside down during the Civil War. The style is heavy and rich, sometimes overblown and melodramatic. The politics which underpin it are questionable, but its products are breathtaking.

The huge glass-and-iron Crystal Palace, designed by Joseph Paxton to house the Great Exhibition of 1851, shows another strand to 19th century architecture—one which embraced new industrial processes. But it wasn't long before even this confidence in progress came to be regarded with suspicion. Mass production resulted in buildings and furnishings that were too perfect, as the individual craftsman no longer had a major role in their creation. Railing against the dehumanising effects of industrialisation, reformers like John Ruskin and William Morris made a concerted effort to return to hand-crafted, pre-industrial manufacturing techniques. Morris's influence grew from the production of furniture and textiles, until by the 1880s a generation of principled young architects was following his call for good, honest construction.

The most important trends in early 20th century architecture simply passed Britain by. Whilst Gropius was working on cold,

hard expanses of glass, and Le Corbusier was experimenting with the use of reinforced concrete frames, we had staid establishment architects like Edwin Lutyens producing Neo-Georgian and Renaissance country houses for an outmoded landed class. In addition there were slightly batty architect-craftsmen, the heirs of William Morris, still trying to turn the clock back to before the Industrial Revolution by making chairs and spurning new technology. Only a handful of Modern Movement buildings of any real merit were produced here during the 1920s and 1930s, and most of these were the work of foreign architects such as Serge Chermayeff, Berthold Lubetkin and Erno Gold-finger who had settled in this country.

Complete the sentences. Write NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the text in each gap.

Because most Anglo-Saxon buildings were constructed from **30** _____, few of them have survived.

The owners of medieval manor houses in Britain earned their reputation through their **31** _____ and elegance.

The 16th-century building was designed to show evidence of **32** _____.

In the 16th century, the use of glass was fashionable, even though it was an **33** _____.

Indigo Jones was particularly skilful in designing architecture in the **34** _____ style.

Though William Morris designed **35** _____, his emphasis on hand-crafting influenced architects.

MOCK TEST 17

35 answers

1 attractions
2 offers
3 castle
4 walkway / lane / lanes
5 views
6 free
7 ferry
8 D
9 E
10 C
11 H
12 B
13 A
14 G
15 VII
16 VI
17 IV
18 I
19 VIII
20 III
21 True
22 False
23 False
24 Not Given
25 True
26 Not Given
27 D / trustworthiness.
28 B / accuracy of information.
29 C / sensible.
30 wood
31 hospitality
32 status and wealth / status wealth
33 expensive commodity
34 classical
35 furniture and textiles